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APPRAISAL : EMPLOYEE APPRAISALS

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EMPLOYEE INFORMATION

Name :	Hung, Sang	Performance:	3
Job Title :	Dir WT Product Mgmt	Capability:	3.00
Division :		Weighted Rating:	3.00
		Overall Rating:	3

APPRAISAL INFORMATION

Evaluation Year :	2011		
Self Appraisal Start Date :	11/17/2011	Due Date :	03/07/2012
Evaluated by :	Edwards, Conrad	Confirmed by :	Packingham, Kevin

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PERFORMANCE RATING	3
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CORE COMPETENCIES	Rating
* Comments are on each competency are not mandatory except for rating 1,4, and 5.	



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CREATIVITY

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Created and refined concurrent user research methodology to maximize the yield of user/product research; increase the recruitment of subjects as well as fully utilize "backup" and "floating" subjects recruited from the primary research project to simultaneous projects run by STA user research team at the same time. This saved STA money as the "backup" and "floating" subjects would get paid even they were not used in any research. Estimated saving in atypical research project was at least \$200 per subject (recruitment cost + subject fee) and we usually would run at least 18 subjects in each research (estimated saving of \$3600 per research project). The biggest possible saving came from the cost of conducting the "Add-on" research as another project (assuming that there was a 50% chance that we would collect enough data and the cost of a typical user research of that size was around \$30,000, we would have saved an additional \$15,000, note that we conduct the research, data analysis and interpretations as well as complete reports ourselves). Adding the subject fees, we were saving at least \$200,000 per year. With the increase in time duration of sessions and the number of research we have been doing, the saving could even be more. We continued this regular practices this year with even larger size recruitments from Jan to Dec as long as circumstances and funding permitted.
2. Created user experience research methodology involving multiple users at the same time but still would get quality data from the research. This increased our research productivity by 3 to 4 folds on average. This also translated to better time efficiency and saved the cost of holding additional sessions (facilities and facilities and moderators cost). We are also running multiple research studies within the same session by increasing the duration of the research sessions. The target time duration is around 2 hours to 3 hours per session this year (we would not run research sessions longer than 3 hours because of user fatigue and possible loss of attention and focus). This approach, together with using "backup" and "floaters" increased our productivity dramatically, we have covered more than 45 research projects this year with 3 to 4 large -scale research projects.
3. Created, designed and implemented user/product research using tablets to capture user responses to lengthy digital products/services usage survey given to participants instead of paper copies. Pioneered and used tablets as data collection tool with MarketTools with the help from STA Strategic Marketing Research when possible. The strategic use of tablets as data collection tools can increase our efficiency by cutting down data entry time and errors. The data of the Screen Lock Preference project (report released Nov 28, 2011) were collected through tablets. This approach saved time and effort in data entry as well as trees, helping us in protecting our environment. We will continue to use this approach in the coming year using better online survey capture tools.
4. Optimized consumer research opportunities by carrying out a tablet-pen interaction research when respondents were using tablets to enter their background information at the same time. The research of comparative tablet interaction methods - finger touch, pen and pen/finger touch was conducted with part of the product experience evaluated with completion of online questionnaire (report released Nov 29, 2011)

Evaluator Comments :

Cost savings work is appreciated; should extend to 2012, and we need to identify ways to outsource quantitative work and continue to expand design research to a more qualitative perspective.

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CHALLENGE

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Smartphone and tablet Form factor Issues – although the future direction smartphone form factor is increasing display size (hence physical size), it is unlikely that users will be able to carry or use large form factor devices such as mobile smartphones effectively. With the support of STA Product Planning, we initiated a series of form factor research which effectively set the limit of physical size of a device as a mobile smartphones. We performed research using both mockups and real devices in the market and found that users would start to have issues with pocketability and one-hand usage of phones with 4.3" or larger display. Although the results were shared with HQ, we were still designing and launching smartphones with larger screens and form factor. While those devices would certainly appeal to some advanced users, the product will not be likely be popular for mass market. We presented our results to D J Koh in March 2011 so that he would have an understanding of the market in the US and will continue to adopt a consumer-driven approach to influence product development.

2. The use of multiple subjects in UX evaluation session of user research posed logistic and experimental challenges to us. Timing of research and the unpredictability and availability of prototypes or samples have enabled us to develop a well-oiled Just-in-Time approach in handling ressearch, the capability of switching or adding research topics at the very last moment. In the recent research on competitive smartphones (Galaxy SII vs. HTC Sense smartphones and Apple iPhone 4s), we also added another research at the last moment on comparing picture quality of the cameras of various smartphones. This was done because we could not get the information regarding with future Galaxy SIII products (comparing consumer preference of the trade-off between form factor with battery life Oct, Nov 2011)

3. It has been very difficult to obtain prelaunch product prototypes or concept models for product experience and usability research for consumers. This included our Galaxy SII smartphones and Galaxy Tab 10.1 as well as Galaxy Nexus and Galaxy Note. This has negatively impacted on the timeline of providing actual consumer feedback and evaluation of our product experience, which can be very different from the media and industry pundits. We will continue to request samples and prototypes for testing and plan on requesting those through different contacts in the company to maximize the chance of getting them in time.

Evaluator Comments :

In general, research work is conducted well. Moving forward; we need to make sure we focused appropriately and drive towards actionable conclusions.

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SPEED

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Using HTC Scribe on Flyer: Pen Tablet Product Experience Evaluation: conducted a fast-paced Pen Tablet research to provide feedback to STA Product Planning team on pen tablet interaction for Galaxy Note. The project was planned and conducted in about 2 weeks (report released August 16, 2011)
2. We conduct research on some of the key competitive smartphone user research with Galaxy SII smartphones within 1 week after launch of competitive products. Examples include Apple iPhone 4s, HTC Amaze and HTC Vivid. (Oct Nov 2011)
3. Timing of research and the unpredictability and availability of prototypes or samples have enabled us to develop a well-oiled Just-in-Time approach in handling research, the capability of switching or adding research topics at the very last moment. In the recent research on competitive smartphones (Galaxy SII vs. HTC Sense smartphones and Apple iPhone 4s), we also added another research at the last moment on comparing picture quality of the cameras of various smartphones. This was done because we could not get the information regarding with future Galaxy SIII products (comparing consumer preference of the trade-off between form factor with battery life Oct, Nov 2011)

Evaluator Comments :

Satisfactory, flexibility has shown value.

SAMSUNG

STRATEGIC FOCUS

3.0

Employee Comments :

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1. Planned and executed user research to support and enhance the strategy, product and UX design of Samsung products/services as informed by different internal organizations including STA Design & Technology, STA Product Planning, STA Strategic Marketing Research, STA Product Management, SDA and HQ Design Group & HQ Product Planning. We planned our research based on our research requests from these organizations as well as our anticipation and assessments of research needs. Examples: Competitive Galaxy SII product/user research (for 4 carriers focusing on was done with request from STA Product Planning; Form Factor research and physical/virtual QWERTY research projects were initiated from STA Product Planning.
2. In order to become and maintain our position as the market leader, our company will need to excel in many different aspects of our products and services (e.g., design, marketing, branding and distribution of our products). As user research organization in North America, we have focused upon the development of a competitive product/service experience consumer research program that will enable us to compare different aspects of product experience (design/ergonomics, usability, product concepts) with competitive products and services. We have used this for competitive product UX analysis and will further seek improvement (and/or possible co-development of a standard product experience benchmark procedure with HQ Design Group). In this way, we can understand the "total" product experience landscape of our products in relation to our competition. The importance of this benchmark is that it is collected from the actual users and representative of users' perspective, and not from any other UX assessments from either the media, bloggers or internal Samsung employees or organizations. This independence would give us a more accurate picture of how our product fared in user experience.
3. Focus of Convergent Product Experience of Tablets & Smartphones: throughout the year, focus was to put to support the Product Concept, Form Factor and UX improvement of Galaxy Tablets (7", 8.9" and 10") before launch. Usability studies as well as comparative product experience evaluation with competitive devices in the market were conducted to uncover major usability issues before launch of Galaxy S devices. These included form factor predictive modeling to usability studies of prelaunch Galaxy tablets, a series of usability and product experience, competitive product experience with tablets from different platforms/OS, Post-launch comparisons of Galaxy Tablets with competitive tablets in the market were also conducted so that we could learn from both our products and our competitors' products. As for the smartphones, we focused more on competitive post-launch product experience. Research has been conducted on the competitive product experience of Samsung Infuse and all the Galaxy SII smartphones for the carriers to identify both strengths and weaknesses of our product experience and differentiating features. Our focus on convergent experience included smart TV/ device interactions and usage of device as remote control of TV, streaming content to TV and content sharing between devices. Research on Smart Hub, AllShare and Kies Air have been conducted. Multimodal interactions with smartphones and tablets were also part of our strategic focus this year (May to Dec 2011).

Evaluator Comments :

Point 2 is valuable here - representing the voice of the consumer. We need to take a hard look at the benchmark and, as mentioned, work with the right folks in HQ Research team to collaborate on a standard benchmark, and market the tools internally. We also need to move the results into a more consumable forum that will increase visibility and adoption of any insights made. Overall, Sang needs to identify a new way to "market" his work to a larger audience, and create a living repository of information that does not rely on powerpoint decks as a means of distribution.

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SIMPLICITY Employee Comments : 1. Continued the use of executive summary, fast facts and/or research insights sections to the research reports to convey complex data and results in a visual and understandable manner throughout 2011 2. Advocated simplicity of design driven by consumer research of product/user experience, e.g., a physical button or a motion gesture to invoke automatic speech recognition in our products (Nov 6 2011) 3. Simplified and streamlined research protocol to maximize the time spent on actual research throughout the year (Jan through Dec 2011). Evaluator Comments : Per earlier comments, we need to move away from PowerPoint, and embrace streamlined data collection, analysis and socialization tools.	3.0
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SELF-CONTROL / EMPOWERMENT

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Actively sought input of critical areas where primary user/product research were needed from Design and Technology, Product Planning, HQ Design Group and Product Management. Initiated, planned, conducted and completed various user research projects that were critical to the company within a relatively short time frame (2 to 4 weeks lead time including recruiting subjects). Examples, a series of form factor and QWERTY (physical and/or virtual) user research projects, competitive product experience of tablets and smartphones, automatic speech recognition, accessories, multimodal input, convergent product experience (see Accomplishments for the completed projects).
2. Effort and time to have research done right: as many of our research started early in the week, we also held some of our research final preparation meetings on Sundays (example; April 24, July 3, Oct 23 and Nov 6 2011). I was also personally involved into most of the research projects from conception to data analysis and report writing and attended most of the research sessions or carried out parallel research sessions. The working hours of research sessions were usually fairly long, from setting up the site and the research to running the sessions throughout the day in practically all the research we were engaged in (typical schedule from 7:30am to about 8:00pm with a 45-minute lunch break).
3. Personal accountability of research data and results: I adopted an open door policy for sharing data with internal organizations whenever is possible. We spent time to ensure that data we collected were valid and put extra attention to the integrity of data (unbiased research methodology, data entry accuracy, appropriate data analysis etc.) and would share data/results with internal organizations upon request so that they can either conduct further analysis or verify that our analysis is done appropriately. Example: We collected, verified and performed data analysis for several different projects requested by HQ Design Group and did detailed data validation, sharing both the results and analysis with HQ Design Group (Examples: Competitive Virtual QWERTY Keyboard performance and satisfaction – Galaxy SII, HTC Sense and Apple iPhone 4s, report to be released before Dec 31, 2011)

Evaluator Comments :

I would like to see an increase in qualitative research as we move forward, and look for ways to increase the sample size of our quantitative research through partnerships with outsourced providers.

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CUSTOMER FOCUS Employee Comments : 1. Research sharing with T-Mobile TUX: presented research findings at T-Mobile Design Research workshop in March 2011. 2. Completed research from specific requests of STA product planning or product management teams on specific products for carriers - QWERTY Keyboard Layout Evaluation, Aegis Keyboard Layout Comparison (report released April 21, 2011), Samsung Galaxy Tab P7/LTE: Visual & Form Factor Experience with focus on Font Size (report released May 7, 2011) Samsung Infuse: Applications User Experience Evaluation and comparison with current phone (report released June 28, 2011), Competitive Product Experience of T-Mobile Smartphones (Galaxy SII, HTC Amaze and LG G2x, report released Nov 20, 2011), Competitive Product Experience of Sprint Smartphones (Galaxy SII, HTC Evo 3D and iPhone4s, report to be released before Dec 31, 2011), Competitive Product Experience of AT&T Smartphones (Galaxy SII, HTC Vivid and iPhone4s, report to be released before Dec 31, 2011), Competitive Product Experience of Verizon Smartphones (Galaxy Nexus, HTC Rhythm and iPhone4s, report to be released before Dec 31, 2011) Evaluator Comments : Satisfactory.	3.0
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CRISIS AWARENESS

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Flexible and backup planning for user research: in the planning of our research projects, we have included contingency plans in case that any of the planned research could not be conducted. The nature of our research dictated us to have "backup" research projects available so that we can swap those into the research sessions at the last moment if needed. We had to use our contingency plans for several research as we did not receive the prototypes or mockups as promised in the timeframe of the scheduled research (or we received the prototypes or mockups after scheduled arrival date). Example: the prelaunch Galaxy SII competitive research was scheduled to be held in late May, but we did not receive any samples at all. Since the research was already scheduled, we put out backup plan in place and did a series of convergent product experience research using Smart TV, Tablets and Smartphones covering AllShare, use of smartphone and tablets as remote controls, smart TV user experience evaluation and different connection methods between smartphone, tablets and TV. Twelve different areas of research were conducted in 4 different cities (May-June 2011)
2. In anticipation of the growing importance of multimodal input and the role of natural language and automatic speech recognition, we had planned and conducted multimodal input research in our parallel research sessions. This foresight enabled us to understand and capture consumer responses and evaluation of different solutions from competitive products quickly. With Apple iPhone 4s launch, Siri became the key differentiating factor of Apple, we were able to complete consumer evaluation of the experience compared with the newest Google Voice Action in Galaxy Nexus and Samsung Voice Command/Voice talk in Galaxy SII and identified key areas to improve or innovat. (Oct-Dec 2011).

Evaluator Comments :

Flexibility is a strong need, given the uncertainty around the product development process and sample availability.

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CONTINUOUS INNOVATION

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Continually sought to improve and advance data analysis techniques and procedures to reduce errors and increase validity and data presentation design to enhance understanding. Examples of these activities included the use and improvements of "Just Right" scale to include "acceptable" ranges gauged by the respondents that would indicate the maximum and minimum design attributes tolerated by respondents (e.g., size of mobile devices), inclusion of scores distribution into research reports so that the trend of user performance or evaluation of products can be seen easily (from July 2011)
2. Investigation and usage of new research tools and equipment: prompted the research team to try out new analysis or research tools to enhance the quality of our research analysis and interpretations. Examples: as part of our foray into ethnographic research, we started to try using wearable camcorder or smartphone camcorder to document key portions of our research sessions rather using stationary camcorder (from Oct 2011)
3. Continually sought to improve and advance research methodology to enhance the research process. Examples included the combination of both traditional usability laboratory style research procedure under "controlled environment" to more realistic situations simulating real-life usage. Example: in comparative speech recognition research, the respondents would complete their usability tasks walking, standing and sitting (Oct, Nov 2011) and in tablet accessories and camera/camcorder research, respondents would use accessories and the smartphone camera naturally in different postures during their evaluations (May, July 2011)

Evaluator Comments :

Need to identify ways to broaden the distribution and adoption of research insights.

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TEAMWORK

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Collaborated with STA Strategic Marketing Research on all user/product research projects: actively sought for critique, feedback and advances in research and testing methodology, protocols, data analysis and research reports for every project done, improving the quality and rigor of the entire research process. (See Accomplishments for the entire list of primary research completed and reported)
2. Collaborated with HQ Design Group and/or SDA on user research projects – example: BlackBerry Usage & Brand Perception Survey (report released Mar 8, 2011), UX customization and design elements across carriers from Motorola and HTC (research team UX evaluation report released Apr 8, 2011), Screen Lock Preference (report released Nov 28, 2011)
3. Supported our team on development and user experience enhancements. Examples included finding the minimum x-height font in WVGA, HVGA and QVGA devices (report released Feb 3, 2011), Opportunity mapping: Socialite: Contextual inquiry into the needs and aspirations for concept phone Socialite (report released Feb 21, 2011), Tablet Placement and Use: Understanding user needs and expectations (report released June 24, 2011), Out of Box Experience: Competitive Packaging Comparison, Samsung Galaxy Tab 10.1, Apple iPad 2 and BlackBerry Playbook (report released Aug 5, 2011), Ad-Hocracy Use Cases (internal research: week of Oct 10).
4. Organized regular face-to-face "STA User Research Results Sharing Workshop/Colloquia" to encourage direct and open dialog with any members from Design & Technology, Product Planning, Strategic Marketing Research, Strategic Marketing Intelligence and Product Managements for participation (March 10, April 28, June 23, Aug 4, Dec 6 2010)
5. Collaborated with various teams within Design and Technology (Concept Creation and Product Planning and Marketing) to initiate and complete user/product research requests. Examples: most of the projects listed in the accomplishments, and Ad-Hocracy ethnographic research with TOCA (report by TOCA released Sept 2011)
6. Collaborated with the HQ Design Group as user research advisor by facilitating the planning and execution of 3 primary user research projects commissioned by HQ Design Group with 2 different vendors (Strategy Analytics and Gist Design) when they conducted their Smartphone UX comparison, Sidekick and Galaxy SII user research (March through July 2011)
7. Initiated and participated in User/Product Research Summit with HQ Design Team sharing both the results of 2010 research and exploring collaboration opportunities for 2011 (Feb 8, 9 2011)

Evaluator Comments :

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LEADERSHIP

3.0

Employee Comments :

1. Set research direction and examples by maintaining the transparency of actual research process covering the planning, preparation, data collection, data analysis and interpretations as well as reports writing with rigor and integrity with them doing the actual research.
2. Advocated the importance of reporting true results and data as well as possible limitations and constraints of the research process.
3. Set example by advocating the importance of discipline and rigor of user research methodology, data integrity and report quality objectivity for both HQ and STA organizations and external vendors (Strategy Analytics, Gist Design, HumnaCentrics). Example: in the data analysis and validation of the research done by external vendors on behalf of STA, we came across reports that did not meet the quality standard we expected in both analysis and presentation (e.g., in comparative tablet form factor validations research and competitive product experience of tablets). We made use of this as a learning experience for our research team as well as for the external research agency by holding an in-depth workshop with the external vendor and internal team. The outcome of the workshop was a set of STA User/Product Research Report Templates and Guidelines where both external vendors and internal employees can use.
4. Delegated challenging research projects (examples: Font Legibility in Different Resolution Displays Screen types, Socialite: Contextual inquiry into the needs and aspirations for concept phone Socialite, Comparative cloud storage and sync services – Dropbox & SugarSync etc.) to the research team and empowered them to plan and run the research. Provided technical support, data analysis and interpretations and insight throughout the process to provide learning opportunities for the team.

Evaluator Comments :

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Total	33.0
Average	3.0

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ACCOMPLISHMENTS & GOALS (Comments Optional)

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Employee Comments :

1. Tablet Product Experience Research (10 research reports)
 - developed ideal tablet form factor model, validated model with devices in market
 - detailed product experience of both Galaxy Tab and competitive tablets including ergonomics and industrial design, out-of-box, user experience, product concept
2. SmartPhone Product Experience Research (12 research reports)
 - developed ideal smartphone form factor model, validated model with devices in market
 - detailed product experience of both Galaxy SIII and competitive smartphones including ergonomics and industrial design, out-of-box, user experience, product concept
3. Convergent Product Interaction Product Experience Research (7 research reports)
 - product experience of Smart TV and Smart Hub
 - product experience of interaction between smartphones, tablets and smart TV
 - eco-system comparisons (cloud-based services: iCloud, SugarSync, Dropbox)
4. Multimodal Interactions Product Experience Research area (including speech-enabled apps) (5 research reports)
 - multimodal text input from smartphones and tablets
 - automatic speech-recognition (e.g., Siri vs. Google Voice Action)
5. QWERTY Keyboard User Performance and Satisfaction (4 research reports)
 - physical keyboard (portrait and landscape) benchmark (varying size)
 - virtual keyboard (portrait and landscape) benchmark (varying display size)
6. Accessories Research (4 research reports)
 - Bluetooth headsets with smartphones and tablets
 - keyboard accessories or dock with tablets
7. Miscellaneous product experience (e.g., font size, new concepts) (7 research reports)

A detailed list of the reports is available.

Evaluator Comments :

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AREAS OF DEVELOPMENT

Employee Comments :

1. Continue to improve the effectiveness and efficiency of user/product research process.
2. Continue to simplify the presentation of complex research insights and results for executive consumption.
3. Develop detailed recommendations and measurable criteria of product improvements based on consumer product experience research results
4. Advocate consumer experience from user/product research as basis for innovative, strategic and differentiable features development.

Evaluator Comments :

FUTURE GOALS

Employee Comments :

1. Become a world-class user and product research expert with both top-notch quantitative and qualitative skills
2. Continue to enhance research methodology and analysis framework and provide valid and insightful results for the company to innovate and improve our products and services to be #1 in the marketplace
3. Advocate professional integrity and ethics as a researcher and scientist

Evaluator Comments :

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MANAGEMENT PROFILE (Comments Optional)

MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Evaluator Comments :

Strong manager of research process and methods.

KNOWLEDGE

Evaluator Comments :

Deep knowledge in research methods and processes.

STRENGTHS

Evaluator Comments :

Research methodology.

AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT

Evaluator Comments :

Continuous improvement in research reports and insights - strive for clarity in conclusion and action.

RECOGNITION & AWARDS

Evaluator Comments :

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OVERALL COMMENTS

Evaluator Comments :

Overall, Sang has completed the research for the requests he receives in a timely, quality manner. Moving forward, I would like STA to drive more of the direction of research and, as mentioned, shift focus towards qualitative research and leverage external partners for quantitative research.

Department Reviewer Comments(Comments Optional):

OVERALL RATING : 3

Performance : 3

Capability: 3.00

TOTAL: $3 * 0.6 + 3.00 * 0.4 = 3.00$ Points (Evaluation Ratio: Performance 60% + Capability 40 %)

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